



CoARA Action Plan

The Foundation for the Promotion of Health and Biomedical Research of the Valencian Community (Fisabio) is a non-profit scientific organisation whose primary goal is to promote, support, disseminate, develop, and implement scientific-technical research and healthcare and biomedical innovation within the Valencian Community.

Fisabio operates across the Valencian Community, integrating and managing R&D&I activities carried out at Fisabio-Public Health (Fisabio-SP) and Fisabio-Health Departments (Fisabio-DS). Fisabio-DS covers 19 out of the 24 Health Departments of the Valencian Community (including their respective referral hospitals, primary care centres, and public health centres), the Valencian Community Blood Transfusion Center, and five Hospitals for Chronic and Long-Term Care (HACLE).

Fisabio provides services to researchers in the Valencian healthcare network, specialists working on research and innovation projects, and clinical studies managed through the Foundation. Additionally, Fisabio coordinates the Valencian Biobank Network.

Membership in CoARA

Fisabio has been a member of CoARA since June 2024, when its membership was formalised. However, the working group established for this purpose had already been working on defining the milestones and tasks included in the action plan attached at the end of this document.

By joining CoARA, Fisabio is committed to reforming research evaluation practices to recognise the diverse outcomes, practices, and activities that maximise the quality and impact of research. This commitment entails the formulation of evaluation criteria and processes that prioritise quality, impact, diversity, inclusion, and collaboration.

Involvement of the Scientific Community in the Change Process

The involvement of the scientific community in the change process is considered to be of crucial importance by Fisabio. Consequently, the entity's action plan must be developed with full consideration for the voices, experiences, and perspectives of the research groups affiliated with Fisabio.

Their involvement is vital for ensuring that the actions outlined in this document lead to the expected success and guarantee the full transformation of research evaluation at Fisabio.

It is imperative to emphasise that this iteration is a **preliminary version** presented within the framework of a **public hearing**, with the objective of eliciting input and feedback to facilitate its refinement. Researchers are invited to review the content and actively contribute with their observations, ensuring that this plan is both effective and adaptable to current challenges in the research field.

CoARA commitment	Line of action	Associated tasks	Deadline	Action Lead	Progress
Commitment 1: Recognise the diversity of contributions to and careers in, research in accordance with the needs and nature of the research.	Identify all the research practices carried out in Fisabio	Survey to researchers	2025	COARA Working Group	
		Construction of a map of diversity of contributions	2025	COARA Working Group	
		Validation by the agents involved	2025	COARA Working Group	
Commitment 2: Base research assessment primarily on qualitative evaluation for which peer review is central, supported by responsible use of quantitative indicators.	Review diversification in evaluation standards	Search and locate agents (evaluation agencies, research groups, etc.) that work on alternative indicators and qualitative metrics	2025	COARA Working Group	
		Identify valid indicators according to research practice	2025	COARA Working Group	
		Associate indicators with research practices	2026	COARA Working Group	
		Open Discussion Forum among FISABIO Researchers on the application of COARA Principles in the institution	2026	COARA Working Group	
Commitment 5: Commit resources to reforming research assessment as is needed to achieve the organisational changes committed to.	Definition and monitoring of the Action Plan after signing the COARA Agreement	Creation of the CoARA working group at Fisabio,	2025	Gerencia	
		Action Plan Definition	2025	COARA Working Group	
		Review and publication of the first version of the Action Plan	2025	COARA Working Group	
		Preparation of the annual Action Plan Monitoring Report	Annual	COARA Working Group	
		Action Plan Update	as needed	COARA Working Group	
Commitment 6: Review and develop research assessment criteria, tools and processes.	Review and update of criteria for internal calls (UNISALUT) and the accreditation of FISABIO research groups Assessment of evaluation criteria for research staff (individual classification) Prepare a proposal for the 2nd Call for cascade funding from CoARA	Drafting of the monitoring report at the end of the Action Plan	2028	COARA Working Group	
		Update internal calls. Review the prioritization of criteria for internal calls	2025-2026	COARA Working Group	
		Update criteria for the accreditation of research groups	2025-2026	COARA Working Group	
		Update criteria for the evaluation of research staff	2025-2026	COARA Working Group	
		Proposal for modality 2 (pilots) to obtain funding from CoARA to promote the reform of research evaluation at Fisabio	2025	Open Science Unit	
Commitment 7: Raise awareness of research assessment reform and provide transparent communication, guidance and training on assessment criteria and processes as well as their use.	Open Science training for researchers Development of support documentation External communication strategy	Specific training about peer-review good practices	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		Specific training on new (alternative) metrics	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		Training about open science publication	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		Writing guides, protocols, recommendations	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		Writing the communication plan	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
Commitment 8: Exchange practices and experiences to enable mutual learning within and beyond the Coalition.	Good practices sharing with similar institutions External sharing	Implementing activities described in the communication plan: training activities, meetings, seminars, workshops, etc.	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		Developing synergies and joint projects with research foundations and institutes	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		COARA Spanish Chapter participation	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		Different working groups participation	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		Elaborate an Action Plan to disseminate the updates of the adherence through various channels	2025	COARA Working Group	
Commitment 9: Communicate progress made on adherence to the Principles and implementation of the Commitments.	Periodic updates on the progress of the Action Plan	Publish a press release to inform on the adherence and next steps	2025	COARA Working Group	
		Social Media coverage of the developments of the activities in this Action Plan (#CoARA)	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	
		Publish Action Plan progress in the FISABIO Annual Report	Annual	COARA Working Group	
		Publish a press release to inform on updates regarding the implementation of the commitments	2026	COARA Working Group	
		Inform on the progress at scientific/academic events to obtain feedback and increase the project's visibility	2025-2026	COARA Working Group	
		Prepare a survey to obtain feedback and increase the project's visibility	2025	COARA Working Group	
		Annually update the Action Plan	Annual	COARA Working Group	
		Publish a press release to communicate achieved milestones	2028	COARA Working Group	
		Communicate achieved milestones internally	2025-2028	COARA Working Group	